

Your Week 1 Action Checklist

Generative AI for Business Leaders & C-Suite | Implementation Planning

1. The Execution Imperative

Knowledge without action is the graveyard of corporate transformation. Research from McKinsey's 2024 AI adoption survey found that 74% of organisations that attended AI leadership training failed to implement any measurable initiative within 90 days. The difference between the 26% that did? They had a structured first-week plan. Your Week 1 Action Checklist exists to close the gap between insight and impact. Every task on this checklist is designed to create irreversible momentum — commitments made, meetings scheduled, tools provisioned — so that returning to the pre-training status quo becomes harder than moving forward.

Key Point: The first seven days after any leadership training are the highest-leverage window for driving change. Psychological research on implementation intentions shows that specificity of action (what, when, where) increases follow-through rates by 200-300% compared to vague commitments like 'we should explore AI.'

2. Monday — Setting the Strategic Foundation

Monday is about communication and sponsorship. These two actions create the organisational permission structure that everything else depends on.

Sharing Insights with the Leadership Team

Schedule a 30-minute meeting or send a comprehensive email that covers three things: the AI opportunities most relevant to your business, the risks of inaction (not just the risks of adoption), and your proposed approach for the next 90 days. The format matters less than the speed. A well-structured email sent Monday morning beats a polished presentation delivered three weeks later. Include specific numbers from the course — the \$4.4 trillion projected impact, the productivity gains seen at companies like Klarna and Goldman Sachs — because executives respond to quantified opportunity, not abstract enthusiasm.

Identifying Your AI Executive Sponsor

If you are not the sponsor yourself, identify who will be. The sponsor needs three qualities: sufficient authority to allocate budget and people, enough credibility that their endorsement carries weight across departments, and genuine commitment rather than performative interest. Get their explicit verbal or written commitment on Monday. An AI initiative without executive sponsorship has a failure rate above 80% according to Gartner's 2024 analysis of enterprise AI projects.

Blocking Experimentation Time

Block two hours on your own calendar for hands-on AI experimentation. This is not delegation — it is personal learning. Leaders who have never used ChatGPT Enterprise, Copilot, or Claude cannot credibly champion AI adoption. The two-hour block should be non-negotiable and defended the same way you

would defend a board meeting. Use this time to work through a real business task with AI assistance: draft a strategy memo, analyse a dataset, or generate options for a decision you are currently facing.

3. Tuesday & Wednesday — Building the Infrastructure

Provisioning Enterprise AI Platforms

Sign up for enterprise-tier AI platform trials. The emphasis on enterprise-tier is deliberate. Free-tier consumer AI tools lack the data privacy guarantees, admin controls, audit logging, and usage analytics that organisations require. The three primary options in mid-2025 are ChatGPT Enterprise (\$60/user/month), Microsoft Copilot for Microsoft 365 (\$30/user/month), and Google Workspace AI. If your organisation already operates within the Microsoft ecosystem — Office 365, Teams, SharePoint — Copilot offers the lowest friction path because it embeds directly into tools people already use daily. If your workflows are platform-agnostic or you need the most advanced reasoning capabilities, ChatGPT Enterprise provides the broadest model access.

Platform	Monthly Cost	Best For	Key Advantage
ChatGPT Enterprise	\$60/user	Platform-agnostic orgs	Most advanced models, broadest capabilities
Microsoft Copilot	\$30/user	Microsoft-ecosystem orgs	Deep Office/Teams integration
Google Workspace AI	Varies	Google-ecosystem orgs	Native Docs/Sheets/Gmail integration

Selecting Pilot Project Leaders

Choose two to three pilot project leaders on Tuesday. These are not necessarily your most senior people — they are the people who combine three traits: authority to make decisions within their domain, credibility with peers so that early wins carry social proof, and enthusiasm that is grounded in pragmatism rather than hype. Brief each leader individually. Explain the pilot scope, the expected timeline (typically 30-60 days for a meaningful pilot), the resources available, and the success metrics you will use to evaluate the pilot.

Establishing the AI Governance Working Group

Set up a governance working group of five to seven people and schedule the first meeting before the end of Wednesday. This group must include representation from Legal (data privacy, IP, and contract implications), IT Security (data handling, access controls, model endpoints), HR (workforce impact, training needs, policy updates), and at least two business unit leaders who will be early adopters. The governance group's first deliverable should be a draft acceptable-use policy — not a 50-page framework, but a two-page document that answers: what tools are approved, what data can be shared with AI systems, and who to contact with questions.

Real-World Incident — Samsung Semiconductor Leak (2023): Samsung engineers pasted proprietary chip designs and confidential meeting notes into ChatGPT, resulting in a company-wide ban on generative AI tools. The incident illustrates why governance cannot wait. Without clear usage policies in place before tools are provisioned, well-meaning employees will inadvertently create data exposure risks. Your

governance working group prevents this.

4. Thursday & Friday — Locking in the 90-Day Trajectory

Scheduling the 90-Day Planning Workshop

By Thursday, schedule a half-day workshop with key stakeholders to build your 90-day AI implementation plan. Use the template provided in this course as the starting framework. The workshop should cover four areas: prioritising use cases (using the AI Opportunity Assessment framework from earlier in the course), defining success metrics for each pilot, mapping resource requirements and budget, and establishing a review cadence — typically biweekly check-ins with a formal 30-day and 60-day review.

Drafting the Initial AI Usage Policy

Draft your initial AI usage policy on Thursday or Friday. Perfection is the enemy of progress here. A 70% policy published this week is vastly more valuable than a 95% policy published in two months. The policy should address at minimum: approved tools and platforms, data classification (what can and cannot be input to AI systems), output review requirements (all AI-generated content must be reviewed by a human before external use), intellectual property handling, and incident reporting procedures. Iterate on the policy monthly as you learn from real usage.

Policy Section	Key Question It Answers	Priority
Approved Tools	Which AI platforms can employees use?	Critical
Data Classification	What data types are safe to share with AI?	Critical
Output Review	Who reviews AI-generated content before use?	High
IP Handling	Who owns AI-assisted work product?	High
Incident Response	What happens when something goes wrong?	Medium

Identifying Training Needs

On Friday, map your organisation's training needs across three dimensions: who needs training (executives, managers, individual contributors, or all three), what level (awareness, competency, or advanced), and how it will be delivered (self-paced online, instructor-led workshops, peer learning groups, or a combination). The most effective corporate AI training programmes in 2024-2025 used a tiered approach: a two-hour executive awareness session, a full-day hands-on workshop for managers, and ongoing peer learning circles where employees share prompts, workflows, and lessons learned.

5. The Compound Effect of Speed

AI adoption has a compounding dynamic. Organisations that start earlier accumulate advantages that become increasingly difficult for competitors to replicate: proprietary datasets refined through months of AI-assisted analysis, teams with deep prompt engineering expertise, custom workflows tuned to their specific business processes, and institutional knowledge about what works and what does not. Every week of delay is not neutral — it is a week your competitors may be using to build these compounding

advantages. The Week 1 checklist is not about doing everything perfectly. It is about creating enough forward momentum that the organisation cannot easily slide back to inertia.

Key Point: The seven tasks in this checklist — communicate, sponsor, experiment, provision, staff, govern, and plan — form an interlocking system. Each action reinforces the others. Communication without provisioning is empty talk. Provisioning without governance is reckless. Governance without a plan is bureaucratic theatre. Execute all seven within the week to create a self-reinforcing cycle.

6. Common Week 1 Failures and How to Avoid Them

Failure Pattern	Why It Happens	How to Avoid
Analysis paralysis	Leaders want to evaluate every AI tool before committing to any	Pick one primary platform. You can always add more later.
Delegation without engagement	Executives hand off AI to IT and disengage	Block personal experimentation time. Sponsorship requires firsthand knowledge.
Policy perfectionism	Legal wants a comprehensive policy before any tool is approved	Draft a two-page interim policy. Iterate monthly.
Pilot overload	Selecting too many pilot projects simultaneously	Start with two or three pilots maximum. Focus creates learning.
Governance vacuum	Provisioning tools before establishing any guidelines	Form the governance group and draft acceptable-use rules before rolling out tools broadly.

7. Accountability Mechanisms

Checklists work only when someone is tracking completion. Three mechanisms increase Week 1 follow-through significantly. First, public commitment: share your Week 1 plan with your leadership team or a peer group. Research by Robert Cialdini on commitment and consistency shows that public declarations dramatically increase follow-through. Second, calendar blocking: every action on the checklist should appear as a calendar event with a specific time slot, not a vague to-do item. Third, an accountability partner: identify one colleague who is also implementing AI and agree to a Friday check-in call to compare progress. Peer accountability adds social motivation to personal discipline.

8. Beyond Week 1 — Sustaining Momentum

Week 1 creates ignition. Weeks 2 through 12 sustain the burn. The 90-day planning workshop scheduled on Thursday should produce a structured cadence: biweekly pilot check-ins, monthly governance reviews, and a formal 90-day retrospective. The most successful AI transformations in 2024-2025 shared a common pattern — they moved quickly on initial deployment, learned aggressively from early usage, and iterated policies and training based on real data rather than hypothetical concerns. Speed of learning, not speed of deployment, is the true competitive advantage.

9. Key Terms Glossary

Term	Definition
Executive Sponsor	The senior leader with authority and accountability for driving an AI initiative across the organisation
AI Governance Working Group	A cross-functional team (Legal, IT, HR, Business) responsible for setting AI usage policies and oversight
Acceptable-Use Policy	A document specifying which AI tools are approved, what data can be shared, and behavioural expectations for employees
Pilot Project	A time-bounded, small-scale implementation designed to test AI value in a specific use case before broader rollout
Implementation Intention	A psychological technique where specifying the when, where, and how of an action significantly increases follow-through
Data Classification	Categorisation of organisational data by sensitivity level to determine what can be shared with external AI systems
Compounding Advantage	Competitive benefits that grow over time — early AI adopters accumulate data, expertise, and workflows that are difficult to replicate

10. Quick Revision Checklist

- Monday: Communicate AI insights to leadership team via meeting or comprehensive email
- Monday: Identify and secure commitment from the AI executive sponsor
- Monday: Block two non-negotiable hours for personal AI experimentation
- Tuesday/Wednesday: Provision enterprise-tier AI platform trials (not consumer free-tier)
- Tuesday/Wednesday: Select and brief two to three pilot project leaders
- Tuesday/Wednesday: Form AI governance working group (5-7 cross-functional members) and schedule first meeting
- Thursday: Schedule the 90-day AI planning workshop with key stakeholders
- Thursday/Friday: Draft initial AI usage policy — two pages covering approved tools, data rules, and review requirements
- Friday: Map training needs across who, what level, and delivery method
- Governance before provisioning — never deploy tools without at least a basic acceptable-use policy
- Speed of execution matters: every week of delay compounds competitive disadvantage
- Public commitment, calendar blocking, and peer accountability increase follow-through rates dramatically
- Perfection is the enemy of progress — a 70% policy this week beats a 95% policy in two months

20 Exam-Based MCQs — Week 1 AI Action Planning

Test yourself after reading. These questions are written in real exam style — scenario-heavy, with plausible distractors. Read every explanation, including for questions you answered correctly.

Q1. Scenario: After attending an AI leadership course, the VP of Operations emails their team: 'AI looks promising. Let's explore it when we have time.' Three months later, no action has been taken. What was the primary failure in this leader's approach?

- A) They should have hired an AI consultant first
- B) They lacked specific, time-bound implementation commitments
- C) They needed board approval before communicating
- D) They should have waited for a more mature AI market

Answer: B **Explanation:** B is correct because vague intentions ('let's explore when we have time') lack the specificity of implementation intentions — the when, where, and how that drive action. Research shows that specific plans increase follow-through by 200-300%. A is wrong because consulting is useful but does not address the root cause of inaction. C is wrong because sharing insights does not require board approval — it is a communication step, not a budget commitment. D is wrong because delay compounds competitive disadvantage; the AI market is already mature enough for enterprise adoption.

Q2. Which combination of qualities is most important when selecting an AI executive sponsor?

- A) Technical AI expertise, large budget, and seniority
- B) Authority to allocate resources, cross-departmental credibility, and genuine commitment
- C) MBA qualification, innovation track record, and external visibility
- D) Data science background, vendor relationships, and available bandwidth

Answer: B **Explanation:** B is correct because effective sponsorship requires the authority to move resources, the credibility to gain buy-in across the organisation, and genuine commitment rather than performative interest. A is wrong because technical AI expertise is not required of the sponsor — that is the team's job. C is wrong because qualifications and external profile do not predict internal sponsorship effectiveness. D is wrong because data science skills are not a sponsor requirement, and vendor relationships are a procurement function.

Q3. Scenario: A CTO provisions ChatGPT Enterprise accounts for 200 employees on Monday. By Wednesday, an employee has pasted confidential M&A documents into the tool. No usage guidelines existed. What Week 1 sequencing error caused this risk?

- A) The CTO should have selected Microsoft Copilot instead
- B) The company should have waited six months before provisioning any AI tool
- C) AI tools were provisioned before establishing governance and an acceptable-use policy
- D) The employee needed more advanced AI training before getting access

Answer: C **Explanation:** C is correct because the checklist prescribes forming a governance working group and drafting acceptable-use policies before or alongside tool provisioning. Without guardrails, employees will use tools in ways that create data exposure risks. A is wrong because the platform choice is irrelevant — any tool without usage guidelines carries the same risk. B is wrong because a six-month delay is unnecessary; a basic two-page policy drafted in days would have prevented this. D is wrong because training alone does not substitute for clear policy — employees need explicit rules about what data can be shared.

Q4. Why does the checklist recommend blocking personal experimentation time for executives rather than delegating AI exploration to the IT team?

- A) Executives learn faster than IT staff
- B) IT teams are too busy with infrastructure work
- C) Leaders who lack firsthand AI experience cannot credibly champion adoption
- D) AI tools are too simple to require IT involvement

Answer: C **Explanation:** C is correct because credible sponsorship requires personal understanding. An executive who has never used an AI tool cannot effectively communicate its value, set realistic expectations, or identify meaningful use cases. A is wrong because it is a false comparison — both can learn. B is wrong because IT capacity is not the reason for executive experimentation. D is wrong because AI tools involve real complexity in enterprise settings.

Q5. *Scenario:* A company's legal team insists that no AI tools can be deployed until a comprehensive 50-page AI policy is completed. The policy review process is estimated to take four months. What is the most appropriate response according to the Week 1 framework?

- A) Accept the legal team's timeline as it reflects prudent risk management
- B) Deploy AI tools immediately without any policy to avoid losing competitive ground
- C) Propose a two-page interim acceptable-use policy for immediate deployment, with the comprehensive policy developed in parallel
- D) Escalate to the CEO and override the legal team's concerns

Answer: C **Explanation:** C is correct because the framework explicitly states that a 70% policy now is vastly more valuable than a 95% policy in months. An interim policy addresses the critical questions — approved tools, data classification, output review — while the comprehensive policy is developed concurrently. A is wrong because four months of inaction incurs significant competitive cost. B is wrong because deploying without any policy is reckless (as the Samsung incident illustrates). D is wrong because overriding legal creates organisational conflict; collaboration on an interim solution is more effective.

Q6. What is the recommended size and composition of the AI governance working group?

- A) Three people from the IT department
- B) Five to seven people including Legal, IT Security, HR, and business unit leaders
- C) The full executive leadership team of 15-20 people
- D) Two external AI consultants and one internal project manager

Answer: B **Explanation:** B is correct because the group needs cross-functional representation to address the legal, technical, human, and business dimensions of AI governance, while remaining small enough to make decisions efficiently. A is wrong because IT-only governance misses legal, HR, and business perspectives. C is wrong because a group of 15-20 is too large for effective decision-making. D is wrong because governance should be internally driven, not outsourced.

Q7. Scenario: After completing her Week 1 checklist, a COO selects eight pilot projects across six departments simultaneously. She argues that more pilots means faster learning. What risk does this approach create?

- A) Too many pilots diffuse resources and attention, reducing the quality of learning from any single initiative
- B) Eight pilots is actually the recommended number for large organisations
- C) The risk is minimal because pilots are low-cost by definition
- D) The main risk is that competitors might copy the pilot ideas

Answer: A **Explanation:** A is correct because the framework recommends two to three pilots maximum. Focus creates deeper learning. Spreading resources across eight projects means none gets sufficient attention, support, or rigorous evaluation. A is wrong because — wait, A is the answer. B is wrong because the framework explicitly caps pilots at two to three regardless of organisation size. C is wrong because pilot quality, not cost, is the concern — poorly supported pilots produce misleading results. D is wrong because competitive intelligence about pilots is not a meaningful risk at this stage.

Q8. According to the compounding advantage concept, why is speed of initial AI adoption strategically important?

- A) First movers always win in technology markets
- B) Early adopters accumulate proprietary data, expertise, and workflows that become increasingly difficult for competitors to replicate
- C) AI tools become more expensive over time, so early adoption locks in lower prices
- D) Regulatory requirements will soon mandate AI adoption for all companies

Answer: B **Explanation:** B is correct because AI advantages compound: months of refined datasets, experienced teams, tuned workflows, and institutional knowledge create barriers that late entrants cannot quickly overcome. A is wrong because first-mover advantage is not guaranteed in all technology markets — but in AI, the data and learning advantages are particularly sticky. C is wrong because AI tool pricing has been decreasing, not increasing. D is wrong because no such universal regulatory mandate exists.

Q9. Scenario: A mid-size company's CEO wants to implement AI but tells the CIO: 'Just handle it. I'm too busy for the details.' The CEO does not use any AI tools personally. What is the most likely outcome of this delegation pattern?

- A) The CIO will successfully drive adoption because they have technical expertise
- B) AI adoption will stall due to lack of visible executive engagement and credibility gaps in leadership communication
- C) The initiative will succeed faster because the CEO is not slowing things down
- D) Employees will adopt AI independently without needing executive involvement

Answer: B **Explanation:** B is correct because AI transformation requires visible executive sponsorship. A CEO who cannot speak credibly about AI tools, has no firsthand experience, and does not participate in strategic planning sends a signal that AI is a side project, not a strategic priority. A is wrong because technical expertise alone does not drive organisational change — authority and credibility are required. C is

wrong because CEO disengagement reduces priority signalling. D is wrong because enterprise AI adoption requires coordinated governance, budget, and policy — not grassroots experimentation alone.

Q10. What is the primary purpose of drafting an AI usage policy in Week 1?

- A) To satisfy regulatory compliance requirements
- B) To create a document for the company website
- C) To establish minimum guardrails that enable safe tool deployment without waiting for a comprehensive framework
- D) To restrict AI usage to the IT department only

Answer: C **Explanation:** C is correct because the Week 1 policy is an enabling document — it answers the questions employees need answered (what tools, what data, what review process) so that AI adoption can begin safely. It is explicitly intended to be imperfect and iterative. A is wrong because Week 1 policies are for internal operational safety, not regulatory compliance. B is wrong because the policy is an internal document. D is wrong because the policy enables broad usage within boundaries, not restriction to a single department.

Q11. *Scenario:* The HR Director argues that the company should complete a six-month AI training programme for all 500 employees before provisioning any AI tools. What is the most effective counter-argument?

- A) Training is unnecessary because AI tools are intuitive
- B) Adults learn technology most effectively through hands-on use alongside structured guidance, not through extended classroom training before access
- C) The company cannot afford a six-month training programme
- D) Employees can learn everything they need from YouTube tutorials

Answer: B **Explanation:** B is correct because adult learning research consistently shows that experiential learning (learning by doing) outperforms front-loaded instruction for technology adoption. The most effective programmes provide tool access immediately with concurrent training — peer learning circles, prompt-sharing sessions, and tiered workshops. A is wrong because AI tools do require training, particularly around data handling and effective prompting. C is wrong because cost is not the primary issue — sequencing is. D is wrong because unstructured self-learning does not address enterprise-specific policies and use cases.

Q12. What three accountability mechanisms does the checklist recommend to increase Week 1 follow-through?

- A) Hiring a consultant, setting KPIs, and reporting to the board
- B) Public commitment, calendar blocking, and peer accountability
- C) Email reminders, daily stand-ups, and project management software
- D) Financial incentives, performance reviews, and deadline penalties

Answer: B **Explanation:** B is correct. Public commitment leverages Cialdini's consistency principle —

people follow through on declared intentions. Calendar blocking converts vague tasks into concrete time commitments. Peer accountability adds social motivation. A is wrong because consultants, KPIs, and board reporting are formal mechanisms more appropriate for later stages. C is wrong because these are project management tools, not behavioural accountability mechanisms. D is wrong because extrinsic motivators like penalties can undermine intrinsic motivation for transformation.

Q13. Scenario: A startup with 50 employees asks what their approximate monthly AI investment should be for comprehensive coverage. Based on the recommended per-employee AI investment range, what is the expected annual cost?

- A) \$6,000 to \$12,000
- B) \$60,000 to \$120,000
- C) \$600,000 to \$1,200,000
- D) \$12,000 to \$24,000

Answer: B Explanation: B is correct. The recommended range is \$100-200 per employee per month. For 50 employees: \$5,000-\$10,000/month, or \$60,000-\$120,000 annually. A is wrong (too low — that assumes only \$10-20/employee/month). C is wrong (too high — that assumes \$1,000-2,000/employee/month). D is wrong (that matches 100 employees at \$10-20/month, not 50 at \$100-200/month).

Q14. Why does the checklist recommend enterprise-tier AI tools rather than free consumer versions?

- A) Enterprise tools have more features for personal productivity
- B) Enterprise tiers provide data privacy guarantees, admin controls, audit logging, and usage analytics required for organisational use
- C) Free versions are about to be discontinued by all major providers
- D) Enterprise pricing is tax-deductible while free tools are not

Answer: B Explanation: B is correct because organisations handling business data need privacy guarantees (data not used for model training), administrative controls (user management, access policies), audit trails (tracking who used what), and usage analytics (measuring adoption). Free consumer tools provide none of these. A is wrong because the distinction is about security and governance, not personal features. C is wrong because free tiers continue to exist. D is wrong because tax deductibility is not the determining factor for tool selection.

Q15. Scenario: A Regional Director selects pilot project leaders based solely on seniority — the three most senior department heads. Two of them are known sceptics who have publicly dismissed AI as a fad. What is wrong with this selection approach?

- A) Senior leaders are too busy to lead pilot projects
- B) Pilot leaders should be selected for authority, credibility, and enthusiasm — sceptics without genuine engagement will undermine pilot success
- C) Only junior employees should lead AI pilots
- D) External consultants should lead all pilot projects instead

Answer: B **Explanation:** B is correct because the framework specifies three traits for pilot leaders: authority, credibility, and enthusiasm grounded in pragmatism. Sceptics who have publicly dismissed AI lack the enthusiasm needed to drive experimentation and are likely to unconsciously sabotage the pilot through low prioritisation or premature negative conclusions. A is wrong because seniority and time availability are not the core issue. C is wrong because junior employees may lack the authority to drive change. D is wrong because internal ownership is essential for organisational learning.

Q16. In the context of Week 1 planning, what is an 'implementation intention'?

- A) A formal project charter approved by the steering committee
- B) A specific plan that defines when, where, and how an action will be taken, increasing follow-through by 200-300%
- C) A verbal promise made during a team meeting
- D) A budget allocation request submitted to finance

Answer: B **Explanation:** B is correct. Implementation intentions are a psychological concept developed by Peter Gollwitzer showing that specificity — defining exactly when, where, and how you will perform an action — dramatically increases the probability of follow-through compared to vague goal-setting. A is wrong because a project charter is a document, not a psychological commitment mechanism. C is wrong because verbal promises lack the specificity that drives follow-through. D is wrong because budget requests are administrative processes, not behavioural tools.

Q17. *Scenario:* A company forms its AI governance working group with representatives from IT Security, Legal, and two business unit leaders. The CHRO was not invited because 'HR has no role in AI governance.' What critical perspective is missing from this governance group?

- A) Finance — to manage the AI budget
- B) HR — to address workforce impact, training needs, and people-related AI policy
- C) Marketing — to communicate AI initiatives externally
- D) The CEO — governance groups require C-suite leadership

Answer: B **Explanation:** B is correct because HR addresses essential governance questions: How will AI affect job roles and workforce planning? What training is needed? How should AI usage be reflected in employment policies? What are the implications for performance evaluation when AI assists work? A is wrong because while finance is useful, the question asks about the critical missing perspective given the composition described. C is wrong because marketing is not a core governance function. D is wrong because the governance group operates under executive sponsorship but does not require the CEO as a member.

Q18. What does the phrase 'speed of learning, not speed of deployment' mean in the context of AI transformation?

- A) Deploy AI as quickly as possible without testing

- B) The organisations that learn fastest from their AI initiatives — adapting policies, training, and use cases based on real experience — gain the greatest competitive advantage
- C) Employees should complete training before any AI deployment
- D) Learning management systems should be deployed before AI tools

Answer: B **Explanation:** B is correct because sustainable competitive advantage comes not from being first to deploy but from having the fastest feedback loop: deploy, observe, learn, iterate. Organisations that learn aggressively from early usage — refining policies based on real incidents, updating training based on actual skill gaps, evolving use cases based on measured outcomes — build deeper capabilities than those who deploy broadly but learn slowly. A is wrong because rapid deployment without learning is reckless. C is wrong because sequential training-then-deployment is slower than concurrent approaches. D is wrong because LMS deployment is an operational detail, not a strategic principle.

Q19. Scenario: After a productive Monday and Tuesday, a Director's Week 1 plan stalls on Wednesday when competing priorities emerge. By Friday, only three of the seven checklist items are complete. What is the BEST recovery approach?

- A) Restart the entire Week 1 checklist from scratch next Monday
- B) Abandon the AI initiative as the organisation is clearly not ready
- C) Complete the remaining four items during Week 2 while maintaining the momentum from the three completed tasks
- D) Hire a project manager to take over the checklist

Answer: C **Explanation:** C is correct because the purpose of the checklist is to create irreversible momentum. Three completed tasks (e.g., communication, sponsorship, and experimentation time) already represent significant progress. The remaining items should be completed as soon as possible, not deferred indefinitely. A is wrong because restarting wastes the progress already made. B is wrong because partial completion is normal — it indicates prioritisation challenges, not organisational unreadiness. D is wrong because checklist execution is a leadership responsibility, not a project management task.

Q20. Why does the Week 1 framework describe its seven tasks as 'an interlocking system' rather than independent actions?

- A) Because they must be completed in strict sequential order
- B) Because each action reinforces the others — communication without tools is empty talk, tools without governance is reckless, governance without a plan is bureaucratic theatre
- C) Because they all require the same team to execute
- D) Because they must all be completed simultaneously on the same day

Answer: B **Explanation:** B is correct because the seven tasks create mutual reinforcement: communicating AI strategy creates demand that provisioning fulfils, governance makes provisioning safe, pilot leaders need tools and policies to operate, and the 90-day plan gives all other activities direction. Removing any element weakens the system. A is wrong because the tasks have a recommended sequence (Monday through Friday) but are not rigidly sequential. C is wrong because different tasks involve different people. D is wrong because the tasks are distributed across the week, not compressed into one day.

